Lecture 1.4: User Input with `prompt`, `alert`, and `confirm`

Why these functions exist

Before building real UI forms, JavaScript provides simple built-in dialog functions. They are excellent for learning, but in production websites they are used rarely because they block the page and cannot be styled.

`prompt()` — ask the user for text

`prompt(message, defaultValue?)` shows an input dialog and returns:

- a **string** if the user types something and presses OK
- `null` if the user presses Cancel

Example

```
var s = prompt("Enter a text", "Some title");

// s is either a string OR null
alert(`You typed: ${s}`);
```

> **Important:** Even if the user types `123`, `prompt` still returns a string `"123"`. If you need a number, you must convert it.

`confirm()` — yes/no decision

`confirm(message)` shows OK/Cancel and returns a **boolean**:

- `true` for OK
- `false` for Cancel

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Example

```
var yesNo = confirm("Are you sure?");
alert(`User said: ${yesNo}`);
```

`alert()` — show a message

`alert(message)` shows a message and pauses execution until the user closes it.

Comparison table

Function	Returns	Common use
`alert`	`undefined`	Display a message
`prompt`	`string` or `null`	Ask for text input
`confirm`	`true` / `false`	Ask for confirmation

Extra insight: handling Cancel safely

Because `prompt` can return `null`, defensive code is important:

```
var s = prompt("Enter your name");

if (s === null) {
    console.log("User cancelled");
} else if (s.trim() === "") {
    console.log("User entered empty text");
} else {
    console.log(`Hello, ${s}!`);
}
```


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Practice tasks

1. Ask the user for their name using `prompt`, then greet them using `alert`.
2. Ask the user “Do you want to continue?” using `confirm` and log the boolean to the console.
3. Handle Cancel and empty input properly using `if` conditions.

JS Refined Notes — Lecture 1.4

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